AFRICAN SOLIDARITY CIVIC ORGANISATION (ASCO)
Registered NPC: 2026/521895/08
SARS Approved PBO: 930092287
Section 18A approved: 9 October 2026
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CORPORATE CSI PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL

Gold Fields / South Deep Community Trust × ASCO

Proposed: South Deep Community Resilience and Environmental Action Skills Project

Requested CSI investment: R50,000

Proposed implementation area: Proposed: a verified host-community ward adjacent to South Deep in the West Rand/Rand West City area, selected through local consultation; an alternative component could be a verified labour-sending community in Eastern Cape or KwaZulu-Natal, subject to Trust confirmation.

Prepared: October 2026

Confidential proposal for corporate CSI / ESG consideration. This document presents a proposed partnership and does not represent an award, endorsement, existing partnership or company commitment.

Executive summary

ASCO is seeking a strategic corporate CSI partnership with **Gold Fields / South Deep Community Trust** to support a measurable public-benefit initiative: **Proposed: South Deep Community Resilience and Environmental Action Skills Project**. The proposed request is **R50,000**, to be applied to direct programme delivery, participation access, safety, learning materials, monitoring and accountable reporting.

ASCO is approved to issue Section 18A receipts effective 9 October 2026. Receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for the approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability.

> **The proposal in one sentence:** Proposed: South Deep Community Resilience and Environmental Action Skills Project in Proposed: a verified host-community ward adjacent to South Deep in the West Rand/Rand West City area, selected through local consultation; an alternative component could be a verified labour-sending community in Eastern Cape or KwaZulu-Natal, subject to Trust confirmation., benefiting Proposed: residents of the selected eligible South Deep host community, prioritising unemployed youth, women, historically marginalised households and community-based groups; final beneficiary numbers and eligibility to be confirmed with local stakeholders and the Trust. through a locally designed, monitored and reportable intervention aligned with Gold Fields / South Deep Community Trust's publicly documented priorities, subject to the company's confirmation of eligibility and application requirements.

What ASCO is requesting
R50,000 in CSI support, or a partial/in-kind contribution structured with the company.

What the funding would enable
Direct activities, participation access, safe delivery, community materials, monitoring and a close-out report.

About ASCO

ASCO is a community-focused civic organisation promoting social justice, community development, active citizenship, African unity, environmental sustainability, inclusion and sustainable public-benefit action. ASCO works through advocacy, education, grassroots initiatives, humanitarian and community-development activities, partnerships and practical interventions.

ASCO is governed by four Directors. The Board governs and Executive Management manages. ASCO maintains governance, donation, safeguarding, financial-management, data-protection, monitoring and reporting instruments for responsible partnership administration.

ASCO's primary contact for this proposal is:

Mr. Bhekisisa (Mdu) Shandu
Executive Director
African Solidarity Civic Organisation (ASCO)
PBO Reference: 930092287
Tel: +27 76 757 5773
Website: https://www.africansolidaritycivic.org/

The proposed project

Project title
Proposed: South Deep Community Resilience and Environmental Action Skills Project

Implementation period
Proposed 6–12 month pilot, with final schedule agreed after eligibility, baseline and permissions are confirmed.

Location
Proposed: a verified host-community ward adjacent to South Deep in the West Rand/Rand West City area, selected through local consultation; an alternative component could be a verified labour-sending community in Eastern Cape or KwaZulu-Natal, subject to Trust confirmation.

Target beneficiaries
Proposed: residents of the selected eligible South Deep host community, prioritising unemployed youth, women, historically marginalised households and community-based groups; final beneficiary numbers and eligibility to be confirmed with local stakeholders and the Trust.

Proposed outputs and targets

The following are proposed planning targets, not completed results. Final targets should be agreed with the company after baseline assessment, budget confirmation and any required stakeholder permissions.

- Proposed target: 1 locally co-designed community action plan and baseline covering environmental issue, participants and safeguarding responsibilities.
- Proposed target: 4 practical community environmental-action sessions (such as clean-up, recycling, water stewardship or greening), subject to permissions and technical suitability.
- Proposed target: 30 participants trained in basic environmental stewardship, safe implementation, monitoring and community project skills, with participation disaggregated by gender and age where appropriate.
- Proposed target: 2 community-based implementation groups supported with simple tools, operating guidance and maintenance responsibilities; procurement and asset ownership to be agreed in writing.
- Proposed target: 1 close-out report with attendance, before/after evidence, waste or area measures where technically valid, lessons learned and a maintenance plan; all targets remain proposals, not completed results.

Expected outcomes

- Improved community participation and practical public-benefit action in the selected location.
- Improved access to relevant learning, environmental, inclusion, humanitarian or youth-development support, depending on the project design.
- Documented implementation evidence, beneficiary participation and lessons for continuation or scale-up.
- Clear accountability through expenditure records, activity updates, monitoring information and a close-out report.

Why this matters

The proposed intervention responds to a community-development need through the sequence **community need → practical intervention → measurable result**. The final baseline will verify the specific need, beneficiary profile, site conditions, permissions and appropriate indicators before implementation.

ASCO will avoid overstating the problem or claiming results in advance. Where waste, participation, learning, environmental condition, referrals or other outputs are measurable, ASCO will use simple evidence tools such as attendance registers, baseline/endline checks, activity logs, photographs with consent, beneficiary feedback and expenditure records.

> **Evidence discipline:** All numbers in this proposal are either company-reported context from official sources or clearly labelled ASCO planning targets. No completed result, partnership or funding commitment is claimed.

Why Gold Fields / South Deep Community Trust?

A R50,000 ASCO project could cautiously align if it is designed as a locally led community-development intervention in South Deep host communities or eligible labour-sending areas, with practical environmental benefits tied to community resilience (for example, community-led clean-up, recycling, water stewardship awareness or restoration/greening) and measurable skills, participation or livelihood outcomes. The community-development components map directly to the Trust's stated purposes; the environmental component is better presented as a supporting resilience outcome because no dedicated South Deep Trust environmental grant category was found. Alignment and eligibility must be confirmed by the Trust administrator before submission.

Verified company context

- Gold Fields states that the independent South Deep Community Trust supports host and labour-sending communities connected to the South Deep operation; the named labour-sending provinces are Eastern Cape and KwaZulu-Natal.
- The Trust's official stated purposes include community development projects for job creation, educational facilities, adult literacy and community infrastructure; community-based self-help, poverty alleviation, empowerment, capacity-building, training and support to emerging micro-enterprises; support to community projects in adjacent communities and labour-sending areas; and funding charitable institutions with similar objectives.
- The Trust forms part of South Deep's Black Economic Empowerment ownership structure and receives annual dividend income from the mine; Gold Fields says the trusts' intended scope is to empower communities to become self-sufficient.
- Gold Fields reports that South Deep community investment has included education and skills programmes through its Social and Labour Plan and South Deep trusts, and that 86 farming jobs in South Deep host communities were linked to SLP projects in 2024.
- Gold Fields' community/ESG priorities include integrated socio-economic development, education and training, health, infrastructure, enterprise development, local jobs and procurement, and long-term community and environmental resilience. Its legacy-programme objectives include climate resilience and protection of water and nature.

- Gold Fields' 2024 group SED reporting separately records conservation and environment as a category (US$0.10m group-wide), but the South Deep Community Trust page does not specify a dedicated environmental-action funding window or published grant criteria.

Company facts are drawn from official sources reviewed for this proposal. They describe public priorities or reported company activity; they are not promises of funding to ASCO.

Indicative project budget

The requested amount is allocated transparently across delivery and accountability categories. The budget is indicative and should be refined with the company after the implementation site, beneficiary profile, quotations and eligible-cost rules are confirmed.

Budget category	Indicative amount	Use
Direct programme implementation	R30,000	Core activities, local delivery inputs and community implementation for the proposed project.
Participant transport and access	R4,000	Reasonable access support to enable participation, subject to eligibility and records.
Safety equipment and participant welfare	R3,000	PPE, first aid, safeguarding, water/refreshments and safe participation requirements.
Educational and mobilisation materials	R4,000	Learning resources, community mobilisation and accessible communication.
Monitoring, evaluation and reporting	R3,500	Baseline, attendance, outcome tracking, documentation and close-out reporting.
Volunteer/project coordination	R3,500	Scheduling, volunteer support, stakeholder coordination and implementation management.
Reasonable administration	R2,000	Reasonable project administration directly attributable to delivery; no inflated overheads.
Total requested CSI investment	**R50,000**	**Equals the proposed request.**

Administration is limited to a reasonable project share. ASCO will not promise audited financial statements unless they are available; it will provide appropriate project expenditure records and supporting documentation.

Partnership options

Option A — Full project funding
Company funds the proposed project at R50,000, subject to approval and agreement.

Option B — Partial project funding
Company contributes a defined portion of the budget, with scope and outputs adjusted transparently.

Option C — Multi-phase partnership
Company supports a pilot followed by an agreed continuation or scale-up phase based on evidence.

In-kind or technical support
Where relevant, equipment, expertise, access or employee volunteering may complement cash support, subject to written agreement.

Accountability and reporting

ASCO will maintain appropriate records relating to funded activities and can provide, subject to agreed requirements:

- Project implementation updates
- Expenditure records and supporting documentation
- Attendance and participation information where appropriate and lawfully collected
- Photographs and activity evidence with appropriate consent
- Safeguarding and incident records where relevant
- Monitoring and outcome information
- Activity and close-out reports

ASCO will agree reporting frequency, eligible costs, procurement expectations, data protection, branding, acknowledgement and any site-access or technical requirements before implementation. Any use of company branding or recognition will be subject to written approval.

Initial contact route

Official Gold Fields page lists Tshikululu Social Investments NPC as administrator. Contact Trust Administrator Mbali Dlanga at southdeepcommunity@tshikululu.org.za; telephone +27 (0)11 5440300 or direct line +27 (0)11 5440409; website listed: https://www.sdtrusts.org.za/. No public application form or open call was found on the official Gold Fields Trust page, so email first to request current eligibility and application instructions.

ASCO welcomes an initial discussion to confirm whether the proposed project is within the company's current CSI/ESG remit, whether unsolicited proposals are accepted, what documents are required, and whether the full, partial or in-kind partnership option is most suitable.

Important conditions and open questions

- The official materials do not publish a current open-call, application form, application deadline, grant-size rule, co-funding requirement or detailed eligibility checklist for the South Deep Community Trust.
- Do not assume ASCO is an existing Gold Fields partner, that the Trust has approved this concept, or that Gold Fields has made any funding commitment.
- Section 18A receipts may be issued only for qualifying donations used solely for ASCO?s two approved Section 18A activities: human rights and democracy, and family stability. This proposal does not represent a completed donation or tax deduction.
- Confirm the precise eligible geography and beneficiary definition with the Trust; Gold Fields distinguishes communities adjacent to South Deep from labour-sending areas, and the official page does not list every municipality or ward.
- Environmental action may require mine/community approvals, landowner or municipal permissions, environmental safeguards and alignment with Gold Fields' policies; avoid implying mine remediation, regulatory compliance or environmental performance outcomes without technical authorization and baseline evidence.
- The official Gold Fields community page describes group-wide priorities and figures; they should not be represented as South Deep Trust commitments or as available funds for this proposal.

These cautions are included to prevent overstatement. They should be resolved with the company before ASCO treats the proposal as eligible or finalises a submission budget.

Closing

ASCO believes meaningful social and environmental progress is achieved through collaboration between communities, civil society and responsible corporate partners. We invite **Gold Fields / South Deep Community Trust** to join us in delivering measurable public-benefit impact through a carefully scoped and accountable partnership.

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Official sources and verification links

Important company and programme information in this proposal was checked against the following official sources:

1. https://www.goldfields.com/foundations-and-trusts.php
2. https://www.goldfields.com/communities.php
3. https://www.goldfields.com/reports/annual-report-2024/host-communities.php
4. https://www.goldfields.com/community-engagement.php
5. https://www.goldfields.com/pdf/sustainbility/foundations-and-trusts/south-deep-community-trust-deed.pdf

Source review and proposal preparation date: October 2026. Company information and application routes can change; ASCO should confirm current requirements before submission.